MELVIN TABITHA OPONDO

Full-Stack Software Developer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I am a full-stack Software Developer with hands on experience building responsive web applications using React.js, Django, and Flask. I design RESTful APIs, manage relational and non relational databases, and deploy scalable systems. I work across the full development lifecycle, from architecture and backend logic to frontend interfaces and API integration.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, JavaScript, SQL, C++, HTML, CSS
Frontend: React.js, React Native, TailwindCSS, Bootstrap, Vite, React Hook Form, React Router
Backend & Frameworks: Django, Django REST Framework, Flask, FastAPI
Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, SQLite, Redis
Tools & DevOps: Git, GitHub, Docker, Kubernetes (learning), Postman, Ngrok, Vercel, Render, Neon, Oracle Cloud, Netlify, Firebase
APIs & Integrations: RESTful API development, Safaricom Daraja (M-Pesa), Google Maps API, OpenWeather, JWT Authentication
Testing: Pytest, Django Test Framework, React Testing Library, Jest
Other: Technical SEO, Canva, Adobe Photoshop

EXPERIENCE

ACSIS, African Caribbean Sustainability & Investment Summit
Web Developer & Graphic Designer

- I developed and maintained the organisation's website using HTML, CSS, JavaScript, and React.js, improving performance and responsiveness.
- I collaborated with designers to translate branding requirements into intuitive, accessible user interfaces.
- I implemented frontend enhancements that improved site load time and cross-browser compatibility.

FEATURED PROJECTS

- **Anga.** Django and React weather platform for Kenyan users that serves live traffic reliably within a 1,000 request per month free tier through usage aware API key rotation and caching with freshness fallbacks. An argument that production grade software can be delivered under tight resource constraints. 222 automated tests. Sole developer. (Live | Code)
- **StudyBuddy.** AI-powered study assistant designed to prevent hallucinated answers reaching students: every generated definition and quiz question is verified against the user's own uploaded notes, and ungrounded responses are blocked rather than shown with false confidence. Django and React, three-role custom auth. Sole developer. (Live | Code)
- **CallShield.** AI-driven real time scam call detection, aimed at giving users a signal before they engage with a scam rather than after they lose money. Django and REST backend, React Native frontend, PostgreSQL. Technical ownership plus Project Manager role.
- **SmartHunt.** Student housing platform with Safaricom Daraja (M-Pesa) payment integration, meeting Kenyan users on the mobile money infrastructure they already use. Google Maps powered location search, Django and FastAPI backend, React frontend.
- **UjamaaFlow.** Resource donation platform built around a three-role flow (donor, recipient, administrator) with auditable payment tracking, because charitable giving collapses without a visible trail from donor to recipient. (Live | Code)
- **Master Photography Kenya.** Marketing website for a Kenyan photography studio in vanilla HTML, CSS, and JavaScript, built for fast image delivery on the variable mobile networks the studio's customers actually browse on. (Live | Code)
- **CSA Africa.** Production hosting, uptime ownership, and technical SEO for the Computer Science Academy Africa website, a real external client whose users depend on the site being up and findable. (Live)
- **Developer Portfolio.** Hand coded in vanilla HTML, CSS, and JavaScript with no framework and no build step, as a deliberate argument that the web platform's fundamentals are enough when they are enough. (Live)

EDUCATION & TRAINING

Meru University of Science and Technology. Bachelor of Science in Computer Science
Computer Science Academy (CSA). Software Engineering
Power Learn Project (PLP). Software Engineering
Africa Agility Foundation. Frontend Web Development
Workmates Technology. UI/UX Design
ALX, AI Career Essentials Program. AI tools integration and ethical AI applications in industry workflows
Kolanya Girls' School. KCSE | 2019 to 2022

LEADERSHIP & VOLUNTEER

Community Outreach Specialist. WISSA, Women in Sustainable STEM Africa. I supported outreach programmes aimed at empowering women and girls in STEM fields across Africa.
Web & Graphic Designer (Volunteer). ACSIS, African Caribbean Sustainability & Investment Summit. I designed digital graphics and promotional materials using Adobe Photoshop and Canva.
Mentor & STEM Advocate. Kolanya Girls' Secondary School. I mentored students in STEM career pathways, leadership development, and facilitated coding workshops.
Social Media Manager. Blockchain Community, Meru University Science Innovators Club. I managed and grew the community's social media presence, creating technical and educational content on blockchain and emerging technologies.

SOFT SKILLS

Leadership & Responsibility • Problem Solving & Analytical Thinking • Team Collaboration • Adaptability & Continuous Learning • Effective Communication

LANGUAGES

English, Fluent | Kiswahili, Fluent | French, Intermediate